

Delaware County Council Meeting - August 18th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oA6WfPBNQg8
Publication Date	2026-08-19T03:56:00Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delvar County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: August 18, 2026

Body: Delvar County Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: The meeting transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting of the Delvar County Council to order on August 18, 2026 [00:09:32](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bookout, Mr. Piper, Mr. Whead (Flanigan), Mr. Chance, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Freeman, and Mr. Mole.
 - **Members Absent:** Not specified.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named, though Council members managed proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** A moment of silence was held in memory of Stephanie Ce Matthew, their families, and all those who suffered loss and hardship over the past week [00:09:38](#), followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:10:12](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Disposition of prior meeting minutes was not addressed; however, the meeting agenda was approved by roll call vote ([00:10:57](#): Mr. Flang - Yes, Mr. Whead - Yes, Mr. Mole - Yes, Mr. Bookout - Yes, Miss Piper - Yes, Mr. Can - Yes, Mr. Hughes - Yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **[00:11:14](#) Special Meeting Focus: 2027 Revenue and Budget Forecast Presentations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council leadership, Jason O'Neal (Policy Analytics), and Scott Finley (Baker Tilly).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council convened a special meeting to review complex moving parts affecting the 2027 budget, including state income tax revenue timing, circuit breaker losses, and the Max Levy Growth Quotient (MLGQ) set at 6.0%.
 - **Policy Analytics Presentation ([00:15:37](#)):** Jason O'Neal presented property tax revenue projections and discussed the impacts of SEA 1 (2025 property tax reform package), which increases homestead deductions up to 2/3 of assessed value by 2031, introduces non-homestead residential/agricultural deductions, restructures business personal property, and implements an unfunded 10% supplemental homestead credit. O'Neal noted a rapid acceleration in assessed value (approx. 15% increase for pay 2026/2027), a shift in the tax base becoming more residential (51% of the tax base by pay 2026), and a 2028-2029 warning light regarding the expiration of local income tax property tax relief.
 - **Baker Tilly Presentation ([00:10:54](#) / [01:05:41](#)):** Scott Finley presented the strategic financial plan covering 2023 through 2030 across operating funds (General Fund, EDIT, LIT, Cumulative Bridge, Health, 911, etc.). Finley outlined impending changes to the Local Income Tax (LIT) structure effective in 2028 (with distributions expected in 2030), warning that General Fund cash balances face steep downward pressure due to budget expansions in 2026, risking negative fund balances by 2028 if spending is not managed to match operating receipts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation and discussion only; no formal legislative votes or ordinances were executed on this item.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:32:51 Steven Brand (County Commissioner's Office):** Cautioned the council regarding the projected \$1 million revenue increase for 2027, noting that Policy Analytics' chart shows only a \$100,000 increase year-over-year thereafter, meaning the "windfall" is short-lived. He also highlighted Baker Tilly's indications that net assessed values may begin declining starting in 2027.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The auditor's office noted that Gateway budget application forms look different this year and that Form 4B data is currently being reconciled with Policy Analytics and Baker Tilly projections.
 - Budget books are targeted to be available on OpenGov within the next 10 days (around August 25th) ahead of upcoming budget hearings.
 - Certified Net Assessed Values (CNAV) submission meetings with the DLGF are scheduled for the following day.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following a motion and second (**02:33:16**), approved by roll call vote (Mr. Plank - Yes, Mr. [Whead] - Yes, Mr. Mogul - Yes, Mr. Bookout - Yes, Miss Piper - Yes, Mr. Pants - Yes, [Mr. Hughes] - Yes).
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